FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MATTRESSES; COTTON (FELTED)

This amendment, which forms a part of Federal Specification V–M–81b, dated December 15, 1948, was approved on the above date by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

Page 1, paragraph **1.2:** Add at end of first sentence "(See **6.6.**)".

Page 1, paragraph **2.1:** Add Federal Specification "DDD–T–86—Tape; Cotton; Bleached, Dyed, or Grey, General-Use".

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.2:** Delete and substitute:

3.1.2 *Cotton.*

3.1.2.1 *Grade A and grade C.*—Cotton for grade A and grade C mattresses shall be new (not previously used), shall have a staple length of not less than ½ inch, and shall be not lower in grade than any of the following United States standard grades for cotton: No. 7 or Low Middling, No. 7 or Low Middling Spotted, No. 4 or Strict Middling Gray (see U. S. Department of Agriculture Miscellaneous Publication No. 310). The use of reginned cotton shall be permitted provided the reginned cotton is equivalent in grade to United States standard grades for cotton: No. 7 or Low Middling, No. 7 or Low Middling Spotted, or No. 4 or Strict Middling Gray. Tinged or stained cotton shall not be used.

3.1.2.2 *Grade B.*—Cotton for grade B mattresses shall be new (not previously used), have a staple length of not less than ⅞ inch, and be not lower in grade than United States standard grade No. 7 or Low Middling (see U. S. Department of Agriculture Miscellaneous Publication No. 310.) (See 6.6.)

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.3.1,** line 3: Delete "paragraph **3.1.2**" and substitute "**3.1.2.1**".

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.3.2,** line 6: Delete "**3.1.2**" and substitute "**3.1.2.2**".

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.3.3,** line 6: Delete "**3.1.2**" and substitute "**3.1.2.1**".

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.3.4,** line 6: Delete "**3.1.2**" and substitute "**3.1.2.1**".

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.6:** Delete in its entirety and substitute:

3.1.6 *Twine (for hand stitching of side, end, and roll-edge).*—The twine shall be waxed or polished. Either cotton twine having a breaking strength of not less than 20 pounds or flax twine having a breaking strength of not less than 24 pounds shall be used.

Page 2, paragraph **3.1.7,** lines 4 and 5: Delete and substitute the following: "cotton unbleached tape conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification DDD–T–86 shall be used."

Page 3, table **I,** line 4, for "Thickness, approx.": For size 7, delete "4" and substitute "4½", and for size 10, delete "4½" and substitute "6".

Page 3, table **I,** last line, for "Weight, minimum": For size 4, delete "23" and substitute "27"; for size 7, delete "38" and substitute "35"; and for size 10, delete "38" and substitute "50".

Page 3, paragraph **3.3.1:** Add the following sentence: "Ends of all seams not caught in other seams or stitching shall be securely backstitched."

Page 3, paragraph **3.5,** last sentence: Delete and substitute: "Tufts shall be given diamond spacing not more than 8 inches apart over the entire top and bottom surfaces. Sizes Nos. 1 to 3, inclusive, shall have a minimum of 28 tufts and sizes 4 to 10, inclusive, a minimum of 38 tufts. Sizes Nos. 11 and 12 shall have a minimum of 68 tufts."

Page 5, paragraph **4.6:** Delete in its entirety and substitute:

4.6 Tufting twine.—The strength of the tufting twine shall be determined on a motor-driven machine equipped with grips of the drum type, not less than 1 inch in diameter.

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The grips through which the load is applied shall travel at a uniform rate of 12 inches ±½ inch per minute. The distance between the centers of the drums at the beginning of the test shall be not less than 10 inches ±¼ inch. Ten specimens from each sample shall be tested and the breaking strength shall be the average obtained from the 10 specimens. If for any reason attributable to faulty operation, the strength of the specimens falls markedly below the average for the set, the results shall be disregarded and another specimen shall be broken.

Page 5, paragraph **6.1**, line 4: Delete and substitute: "1.2, 1.3, 3.1.4, 3.7, 3.8, 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 5.1, 7.2.2, 7.2.3, 7.2.4.1, 7.2.4.2, and 7.4.)"

Page 6, section **6**: Add paragraph **6.6** as follows:

The availability of the different grades of cotton linters and staple cotton varies according to seasonal and market conditions. During an emergency the supplies of cotton linters and ⅞-inch-and-longer staple cotton may become critical, the former being required for use in chemical production and the latter as spinnable length fiber required for the production of thread and fabrics. Staple cotton not less than ½ inch in length as described in paragraph 3.1.2.1 is suitable for cotton felt mattresses, grade A of paragraphs 1.2 and 3.1.3.1 and was made available for mattress production during World War II. If conservation of critical materials is ordered by the Munitions Board in an emergency, grade A mattresses should be specified in requisitions, and contracts or orders in lieu of mattress grades containing linters.

Pages 6, 7, 8, and 9, paragraphs **7.2** through **7.2.5**: Delete in their entirety and substitute paragraphs **7.2** through **7.2.5.2** as follows:

7.2 Army.

7.2.1 *Applicable specifications.*

Federal Specifications:

UU–P–268—Paper; Kraft, Wrapping.
CCC–B–811—Burlap; Jute.
CCC–O–721—Osnaburg; Cotton.
LLL–B–636—Boxes; Fiber, Solid (for Domestic Shipment).

Military Specifications:

JAN–P–125—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Barrier-Materials, Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL–B–3149—Baling of Clothing and Equipage.

U. S. Army Specification:

100–2—Standard Specification for Marking Shipments by Contractors.

(Copies of specifications required for Army purchases may be obtained upon application to the procuring agency or as directed by that agency. Both the title and identifying symbol or number should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

7.2.2 *Sampling.*—Sampling shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order.

7.2.3 *Inspection.*—Inspection shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order.

7.2.4 *Packing.*

7.2.4.1 *For domestic shipment.*—Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, mattresses shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of 7.2.4.2, except that the wrapping with waterproof barrier-material, type B–2, shall not be required.

7.2.4.1.1 *Wrapping.*—Alternatively, if specified in the contract or order, three mattresses shall be stacked flat with edges flush and neatly wrapped together in not less than three thicknesses of No. 2 kraft paper having a combined basis weight of 200 pounds, with no sheet weighing less than 60 pounds per ream (24 x 36—500) and conforming to Federal Specification UU–P–268; the wrapping shall consist of not more than two pieces with the edges overlapping not less than 5 inches, and the seam at the center of the side of the package. Ends of the package shall be neatly folded with not less than 10 inches overlap and securely taped with 60-pound-basis-weight gummed-kraft-paper tape, not less than 3 inches wide. The completed package shall be further secured by tying with 2-ply twisted jute, sisal, or other suitable cord having a tensile strength of not less than 288 pounds. Twine shall be applied in one piece dividing the length of the package into four equal segments and the width into three equal segments. Nonslip knots shall be made at each cross-over of cord.

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7.2.4.1.2 *Bags.*—Alternatively, if specified in the contract or order, three mattresses shall be stacked flat with edges flush and packed in a prefabricated paper bag made of not less than three thicknesses of No. 2 kraft paper having a combined basis weight of 200 pounds, with no sheet weighing less than 60 pounds per ream. The bags shall be fabricated, sealed, and closed in conformance with the requirements outlined in Consolidated Freight Classification No. 18, Supplement No. 7, package 12–F. Each package shall be tied with twine as specified in 7.2.4.1.1, for the wrapped mattresses.

7.2.4.1.3 *Boxes.*—Alternatively, if specified in the contract or order, three mattresses shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box made in conformance with the requirements of Federal Specification LLL–B–636, style OLC with full overlap outer flaps. The opening shall be on the ends or the smallest panel of the box. All flaps shall be securely sealed with a good-quality adhesive applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps. Each box shall be reinforced with three flat steel straps not less than ⅜ inch x 0.015 inch, two applied girthwise approximately one-quarter the distance from each end of the box over the sides, top, and bottom, and the third applied lengthwise centered over the ends, top, and bottom. Fiberboard protectors shall be used under straps at edges of boxes coming into contact with strapping.

7.2.4.2 *For overseas shipment.*—Unless otherwise specified in contract or order, three mattresses shall be stacked flat with edges flush and neatly wrapped together in a No. 2 kraft paper having a basis weight of not less than 45 pounds per ream (24 x 36—500), conforming to Federal Specification UU–P–268, grade B, except that the paper shall be creped to have not less than 15 percent stretch in each direction. The wrapped mattresses shall then be protected with an additional wrap of waterproof barrier-material conforming to the requirements for type B–2 of Military Specification JAN–P–125. The wrapped mattresses shall be protected for shipment by a cloth covering material of cotton osnaburg not less than 7 ounces to the square yard conforming to Federal Specification CCC–O–721, or jute burlap, 40-inch, 10 ounces per linear yard, conforming to Federal Specification CCC–B–811. Covering material shall be applied by one of the following methods:

(*a*) The cloth covering and closures shall conform to Method I or II of Military Specification MIL–B–3149 except that bias sewn tubing shall be of sufficient size to fit the wrapped bundle of three mattresses snugly.

(*b*) The cloth covering and closure shall conform to Method III of Military Specification MIL–B–3149.

7.2.4.2.1 Alternatively, if specified in the contract or order, three mattresses may be wrapped together in waterproof barrier-material similar to type B–2 of Military Specification JAN–P–125, except that the material shall consist of one ply of 40-pound paper, 40 pounds of asphalt, and a ply of 60-pound paper with the 60-pound ply placed next to the mattresses. The barrier material shall meet the bleeding-test requirements of Military Specification JAN–P–125. When this material is used an inner wrap of plain kraft paper may be omitted. Each pack shall then be protected with cloth covering material as specified in 7.2.4.2.

7.2.4.2.2 Alternatively, if specified in the contract or order, three mattresses may be packed in a laminated asphalt-paper-cloth tubing barrier-material conforming to the requirements outlined in Military Specification JAN–P–125, type G–2c or G–3c, except that the inner ply of paper shall be 40 pounds basis weight (24 x 36—500) instead of 30 pounds as specified. The barrier material shall meet the bleeding test requirements of Military Specification JAN–P–125. When this material is used, an inner wrap of plain kraft paper may be omitted.

7.2.5 *Marking.*—Bales or boxes shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of U. S. Army Specification 100–2, except that the service color marking will not be required for domestic shipment.

7.2.5.1 *For domestic shipment.*—Bales for domestic shipment, *not* containing waterproof barrier-material, in addition to the regular marking, shall have a domestic shipment code "DOMPK" immediately following the stock

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number or nomenclature as illustrated in the following example:

Example:

Stock No.
DOMPK
Nomenclature
Quantity Size
Weight Cube

7.2.5.2 *For overseas shipment.*—Bales for overseas shipment, containing waterproof barrier-material, shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of U. S. Army Specification 100–2, with the service color marking applied for the Army in Quartermaster green. No other identification will be necessary.

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